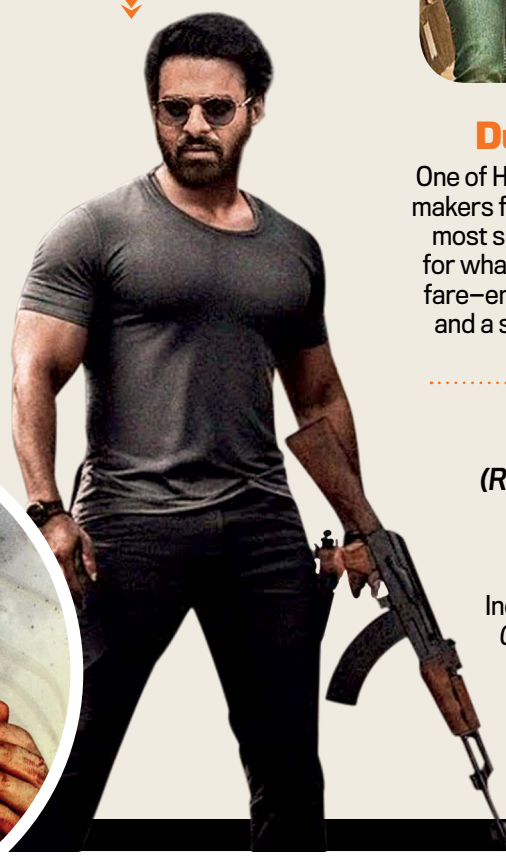
Animal
(Releasing Dec. 1)

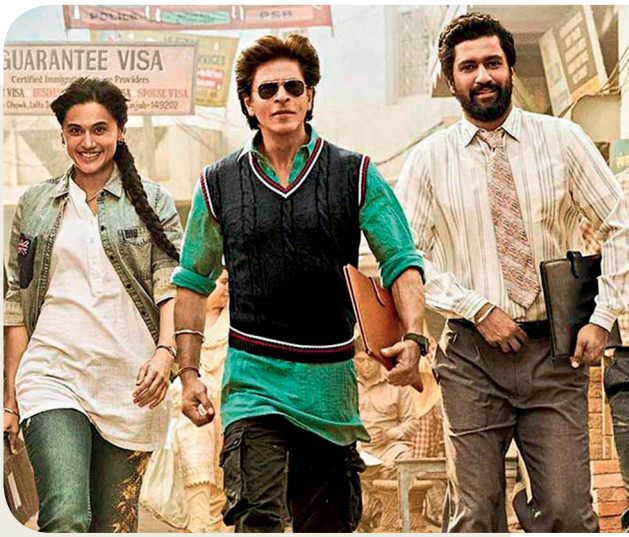
Both Ranbir Kapoor and producers T-Series are betting big on director Sandeep Reddy Vanga to deliver another *Kabir Singh*–like hit with this romantic drama with a violent streak. Going by the songs, Vanga has created another self-destructive and passionate lover for men to cheer for. Also starring Anil Kapoor, Rashmika Mandanna and Bobby Deol



Salaar-1
(Releasing Dec. 22)

K.G.F director Prashanth Neel makes his Telugu feature debut with one of the industry's biggest stars, Prabhas. Expect plenty of action here. Also starring Malayalam star Prithviraj Sukumaran and Shruti Haasan





Dunki *(Releasing Dec. 22)*

One of Hindi cinema's most celebrated filmmakers finally joins hands with one of India's most successful stars, Shah Rukh Khan, for what looks like typical, bankable Hirani fare—endearing characters, lots of laughs and a story that champions the inherent goodness of mankind

Fighter
(Releasing Jan. 25)

Pathaan filmmaker Siddharth Anand's next is apparently India's answer to *Top Gun*. Hrithik Roshan plays a fighter pilot, with Deepika Padukone as both his colleague and love interest



to Mumbai during the pandemic, the idea was to keep things "basic" with his Hindi-language debut. "I don't feel I should tell an intelligent film. I should communicate what I am feeling," he said at the recent India Today Conclave in Mumbai. The collaborative streak will continue in the coming year as Jr NTR joins YRF's Spy Universe with the second instalment of *War*, alongside Hrithik Roshan.

Box office collections are only expected to grow in 2024. Multiplex giant PVR Inox will have added 150 screens by the end of this fiscal year, that too in smaller, hitherto unpenetrated markets like Patna, Bhubaneswar, Jodhpur, Dharwad and Cuddalore. In fact, PVR Inox recorded its highest-ever monthly admissions and box office month in August this year, with nearly 19 million viewers and a gross box office revenue of Rs 532 crores. Alongside Hindi titles, *Jailer* (Tamil) and *Oppenheimer* (English), contributed to the feat.

Some insiders argue that Bollywood's strong showing—as also last year's downswing—was just a matter of circumstance. "Such is the nature of our business and diversity of our content that you see these ups and downs," says Sanjeev Bijli, PVR Inox executive director. Though, he does credit Shah Rukh Khan's "universal appeal" for the success of *Pathaan* and *Jawan*.

Khan himself isn't done yet. The 58-year-old actor will be looking to score a hat-trick of superhits this year with his December release *Dunki*, his first collaboration with one of India's most successful filmmakers, Rajkumar Hirani. Irrespective of whether *Dunki* enters the exclusive Rs 500 crore club or not, one can be sure it will only add to the success story Bollywood has scripted for itself this year. ■